REJECTING POST-HUMANISM, HUMANISM AND ANTI-HUMANISM; WHAT COMES NEXT?

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ABSTRACT

Implications of Malabou's and Badiou's contemporary accounts of subjectivity.

Watkin recently claimed, “French philosophy today is laying fresh claim to the human” which constitutes “a series of fundamentally independent and yet strikingly simultaneous initiatives arising across the diverse landscape of French thought to transform and rework the figure of the human” (Watkin 2016, 1). If we follow Watkins, the least partial way to characterize the recent trajectory of contemporary French thought is a rejection of both the conceptual division between humanism and anti-humanism and the discourse of post-humanism—that Watkin calls “beyond the trichotomy” (2016, 2). Instead, in the wake of humanism, anti-humanism and post-humanism, Watkin sees “new figures of the human” (Watkin 2016, 1) present in the positive projects of Serres, Latour, Meillassoux, Badiou and Malabou. The schema of ‘beyond the trichotomy’ is a useful way to characterize these philosophical projects that distance themselves from the linguistic paradigm of deconstructionism and phenomenology. However, unlike Watkins, I will argue that a more conceptually rich way of thinking about these projects is through the lens of exceeding finitude that defines the subject outside of Watkin’s trichotomy. What comes next? New visions of subjectivity.

What are the consequences for music? Of this group, Badiou is the only philosopher to have ventured an answer to such a question. This paper explores initial ideas in this direction.